

KING HARDFIRE

Dwarf King of Gondor • Unifier

Medium Humanoid (Dwarf), Lawful Neutral • Born 5935 A.T. • Secretly Raising a Black Dragon

Armor Class:	22 (Adamantine Full Plate + Shield)	Challenge:	15 (13,000 XP)
Hit Points:	195 (18d8 + 108)	Proficiency:	+5
Speed:	25 ft.	Languages:	Common, Dwarvish, Giant, Undercommon

ABILITY SCORES

STR

22

+6

DEX

10

+0

CON

24

+7

INT

16

+3

WIS

18

+4

CHA

16

+3

SAVING THROWS

- STR +11
- CON +12
- WIS +9
- INT +8
- DEX +0
- CHA +3

SKILLS

- Athletics +11
- History +8
- Insight +9
- Intimidation +8
- Perception +9

SENSES & DEFENSES

Senses:	Darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 20, Tremorsense 30 ft.
Resistances:	Fire, Poison
Cond. Immune:	Poisoned

TRAITS & FEATURES

Unifier of Clans. Hardfire united the Hardheart and Fireheart dwarf families, ending centuries of rivalry. His presence gives allies advantage on saves against being frightened or charmed.

Secret Dragon Keeper. Hardfire is secretly raising a baby black dragon in the deep mines, intending to use it as a weapon against the goblin hordes. This would be considered treason by most surface kingdoms.

Dwarven Resilience. Hardfire has advantage on saving throws against poison and resistance to poison damage.

Stone's Endurance. Hardfire can reduce damage from an attack by 1d12 + 7. (1/short rest)

Master Smith. Hardfire crafted his own armor and weapons. They are considered +3 magical items.

KING HARDFIRE — Continued

ACTIONS

Multiattack. Hardfire makes three Forge Hammer attacks.

Forge Hammer (+3). Melee Weapon Attack: +14 to hit, reach 5 ft. Hit: 18 (2d8 + 9) bludgeoning + 7 (2d6) fire damage.

Shield Bash. Melee Weapon Attack: +11 to hit. Hit: 12 (1d8 + 6) bludgeoning, target must DC 19 STR save or be knocked prone and pushed 10 ft.

Magma Surge (1/Day). A 30-ft. cone of molten rock. DC 20 DEX save, 45 (10d8) fire damage on fail, half on success. Area becomes difficult terrain.

REACTIONS

Shield Wall. When an ally within 5 ft. is attacked, Hardfire grants +3 AC to that ally until the start of his next turn.

LORE & ESSENCE

"A dwarf divided is a dwarf defeated. Under my hammer, we are one."

King Hardfire accomplished the impossible: uniting the Hardheart and Fireheart dwarf clans under a single crown. His kingdom of Gondor thrives under his rule, the forges burn bright, and the mines run deep. But in the deepest tunnel, far from prying eyes, Hardfire keeps a secret — a baby black dragon he is raising as a weapon against the goblin menace. He tells himself it is necessary. He tells himself he can control it. History suggests otherwise.

KEY RELATIONSHIPS

King Grudge. The orc king to the north. A growing threat Hardfire watches carefully.

Othorian Nel. An ally of convenience. Hardfire respects the elf but keeps his dragon secret close.

The Baby Dragon. His most dangerous secret. A weapon or a disaster in the making.